

Three complete directions. One shared musical engine.

Recommendation: begin with Phrase; borrow Trail’s short session planning and add Pocket’s richer band experience after the feedback earns trust.

01

Phrase

The unit of progress is a phrase you can reliably play.

A calm rehearsal workbench that turns a score into a map of what you can play, at which tempo, and what to work on next.

18–22 weeks to complete beta

02

Trail

The unit of progress is a skill demonstrated in your own music.

A guided practice companion that builds short, adaptive sessions from the pieces a musician actually wants to learn.

20–26 weeks to complete beta

03

Pocket

The unit of progress is a musical role performed reliably in context.

A rehearsal room with a convincing backing band, where musical challenges and take reviews turn practice into playing.

22–28 weeks to complete beta

Read the books in this order

Pages 1–7: concept, storyboard and interface. Pages 8–14: system, music, sound, jam generation, assessment and data. Pages 15–17: delivery, acceptance gates and evidence. Each book stands alone; shared infrastructure is deliberately consistent.

What was produced

Three 17-page design books plus this comparison. Original vector mockups and diagrams, linked sources and local sample analysis. No application was built or changed.

Three distinct ways to organize practice

All three retain a simpler Guitar Pro-style playing interface. They differ in what chooses the next action and what progress means.

Decision	Phrase	Trail	Pocket
First question	Which phrase needs work?	What should I practice today?	What do I want to play with?
Home and main screen	Piece map → score workbench	Today plan → mission score	Set list → rehearsal score
Feedback emphasis	Exact event and transition evidence	One learning objective at a time	Timing and role in musical context
Core reward	Reliable phrase tempo; connected sections	Demonstrated skill; recall and transfer	Saved rehearsal; consistent groove
Jam’s role	Transfer a phrase into another context	Prove a skill over a new harmony	Create the main playing experience
Unique complexity	Phrase boundaries and readiness rollups	Pedagogy, planning and content operations	Style arranging, samples and groove logic
Product risk	Too much analysis on the screen	Guidance becomes generic or restrictive	Backing band sounds stiff or repetitive
Best starting audience	Self-directed repertoire learners	Players who need practice structure	Players motivated by jamming and groove

Every design includes the complete requested loop

This matrix points into each standalone book. Initial release capabilities and later assessment expansions are distinguished throughout.

User objective	Where it is designed	First complete beta / later expansion
Upload Guitar Pro and other digital music	pp. 2, 8–9	GP3–8 and MusicXML with a feature report. Original-file retention and a canonical score; PDF/image OCR deferred.
Sheet music or tablature; simple familiar UI	pp. 3–4, 9	Central score / TAB / both; selected tracks, keyboard controls and a focused tablet layout.
Playback at different speeds; loop sections	pp. 4, 10	A–B loops, tempo control, count-in, rest, mute/solo and repeat rules. Imported recordings use a distinct sync path.
High-quality musical instruments and samples	pp. 8, 10, 15–16	Curated sampled core band with a listening gate. Licensed/commissioned packs; broader GM fallback and later articulations.
Evaluate current audio performance	pp. 5, 12–13	Validated clean single-note guitar/bass plus rhythm grading. Confidence and coverage visible. Chords and technique grading extend by benchmark.
Feedback, exercises and gamification	pp. 3, 5–6, 13–15	Evidence → targeted drill → in-piece retest. Rewards differ by concept; uncertain input never reduces mastery.
Track note/timing accuracy across tempos	pp. 6, 13–14	Versioned takes, phrase-tempo history, note counts, timing distributions, retained checks and optional account sync.
Natural-language jam patterns → backing	pp. 7–8, 10–11	Text or form → validated recipe → deterministic musical arrangement → sampled playback, editable score and practice mode.

Choose the smallest learning loop that feels valuable

A proposed decision sequence for the next phase. Implementation begins only after selecting a direction; this delivery contains design work only.

Start with Phrase’s core loop

Import one piece, select one part and phrase, play a baseline, inspect one trustworthy observation, practice a targeted exercise and retest. This connects every core learning capability with the least product machinery.

Validate sound and assessment first

The score parser is promising: all three local files loaded with alphaTab 1.8.4. Fidelity still needs checking, including bend fallback warnings and GP8 sync. Recognition quality and musical sound are the primary unknowns.

Run three focused product tests

Use the storyboards with 12 guitarists/bassists. Observe which next action they expect, whether feedback feels fair, and what evidence convinces them they improved. Then test the chosen loop with recorded performances and a musician-labeled reference.

Share infrastructure; commit to one behavior

All concepts use the same score model, sampler, input/evidence pipeline and history. Build one product shell first. Trail’s planner and Pocket’s director can become later modes once the core practice value is established.

Three decisions for the next planning round

1. Which concept’s daily practice loop would you most want to use?

2. Is a wired interface a reasonable recommendation for precise grading, while microphone practice remains supported?

3. Which first tone/style pack matters most: blues/shuffle, rock, or jazz?

What remains unproven

No user study, audio benchmark, rendering comparison, sound audition or production performance test has been run. Estimates assume three engineers and specialist musical input. The plans include exit gates so these uncertainties can be resolved early.